MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DEVOPS / CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE ENGINEER | QA AUTOMATION & TEST INFRASTRUCTURE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer transitioning toward DevOps and cloud infrastructure, with hands-on experience owning CI/CD pipelines and building ephemeral test environments deployed to a shared Kubernetes cluster, alongside personal infrastructure projects using k3s and Terraform on Hetzner. Applies infrastructure automation and GitOps in a personal k3s homelab, including Terraform provisioning for a Hetzner VPS. Experienced in improving pipeline performance, test-environment reliability and observability, and in documenting technical processes and supporting cross-functional teams.

CORE SKILLS

Infrastructure & Platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access on shared cluster; personal k3s cluster), Helm, Docker, Docker Compose, Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS), Argo CD, Linux
CI/CD & Automation: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Bash, Python, Ansible (basic)
Observability & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Networking & Security: Traefik ingress, TLS certificate management with cert-manager (personal homelab)
Cloud Learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Other: Git, Java (test code)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived, per-merge-request test environments comprising the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data. Deployed with Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster through GitLab CI; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity. These environments enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against isolated environments.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Developed Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding; collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards to help teams identify recurring flaky tests.
- Wrote the internal guide to how the CI system works, now used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Delivered per-merge-request environments for feature review and end-to-end testing, using Helm deployments to the shared Kubernetes cluster.

- Automated environment creation and cleanup through GitLab CI, including removal after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- The flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the most frequent failures.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Certified Tester Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — studying; exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)